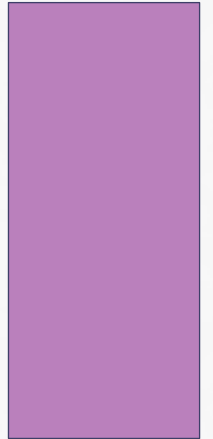


CHAPTER THREE

THE EVOLUTION OF

INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATIONS



**SECTION ONE THE EMERGENCE AND
EARLY DEVELOPMENT OF
INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATIONS**

I. THE ORIGINS OF INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATIONS

- (1) Prerequisites for the Emergence of International Organizations:
 - - The formation of a multi-state system composed of independent sovereign states
 - - The development of multilateral interactions among nations
 - - These factors directly led to Europe becoming the birthplace of international organizations.
- (2) Preconditions:
 - - The Industrial Revolution and the growth of capitalist economies in Europe promoted the continuous development of international trade and interactions, gradually forming a global market.
 - - The rising demand for international cooperation in functional areas and the increasing need for permanent international institutions to coordinate relations directly led to the emergence of early international organizations, represented by international administrative unions.

I. THE ORIGINS OF INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATIONS

- (3) Practical Reasons:
 - - The brutal primitive accumulation of capital during the Industrial Revolution, the frequent wars among European capitalist nations, and the increasingly devastating nature of these wars.
 - - Consequently, governments began to explore new forms of international engagement and cooperation, directly leading to the emergence of multilateral international conferences, exemplified by the “Concert of Europe”.
- (4) Root Causes:
 - - The early emergence of ideas about international organization.
 - - These ideas advocated unity and peaceful means to prevent war, proposing the establishment of permanent international institutions or a world government as a remedy for societal ills.

EARLY IDEAS ON INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATION

- Dante Alighieri: In *De Monarchia* (On World Empire), he proposed the concept of a “unified humanity” and “a league of united nations,” advocating the creation of an international organization capable of maintaining peace. He was the first in Western political thought to put forward such a proposal.
- Pierre Dubois: In *De Recuperatione Terrae Sanctae* (The Recovery of the Holy Land), he called for all Christian states to unite and resolve their disputes through arbitration to prevent war. Any state that violated the collective agreement would be subjected to military sanctions—a pioneering concept of modern sanctions.

- King Henry IV of France and his minister Maximilien de Béthune, Duke of Sully: They envisioned a league composed of European Christian states, with a supreme council—the General Council—made up of delegates appointed by each member state, aimed at achieving lasting peace.
- Hugo Grotius: In *De Jure Belli ac Pacis* (On the Law of War and Peace), he urged the European powers embroiled in the Thirty Years' War to establish a body of laws governing war and peace, sign peace treaties, and use international law to restrain warfare.

- William Penn: In *An Essay towards the Present and Future Peace of Europe*, he proposed that European states unite and appoint representatives in proportion to their size to form a “European Parliament.” This body would oversee arms reduction and peacefully resolve interstate disputes, making decisions by a two-thirds majority and arranging seating around a round table to symbolize equality.
- Abbé de Saint-Pierre: In *Project for Perpetual Peace in Europe*, he advocated the creation of a permanent league of European nations, with each state’s territory and obligations codified in a treaty. Any amendment to the treaty would require the consent and guarantee of at least three-quarters of the members.

- Jean-Jacques Rousseau: He supported the establishment of a European federation, arguing that all international disputes should be submitted to a federal assembly for adjudication or judicial settlement.
- Immanuel Kant: In *Perpetual Peace: A Philosophical Sketch*, he proposed a “league of peace” (foedus pacificum). Kant argued that perpetual peace is both a moral imperative and the inevitable direction of human history. Guided by reason, he envisioned a voluntary confederation of European republics working collectively to secure lasting peace.

II. THE EMERGENCE OF INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATIONS (THE CONCERT OF EUROPE)

Date	Key Events of the Concert of Europe
March 1, 1814	Britain, Russia, Austria, and Prussia signed the Treaty of Chaumont to maintain their coalition against France.
1814	The Congress of Vienna: Britain, Russia, Austria, Prussia, and France established a “new European order” based on territorial redistribution.
September 1815	The rulers of Russia, Austria, and Prussia formed the Holy Alliance in Paris.
November 20, 1815	Britain, Russia, Prussia, and Austria signed the Quadruple Alliance Treaty in Paris, valid for 20 years.
1818	France joined the alliance, forming the Quintuple Alliance.
—	The Concert of Europe—a system dominated by these five great powers—was thus established.
1912–1913	The London Conference—the final meeting of the Concert of Europe.

CHARACTERISTICS OF THE CONCERT OF EUROPE AND THE EMERGENCE OF INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATIONS

1. The Concert of Europe institutionalized regular conferences, establishing multilateral diplomacy as a relatively stable system, thereby directly fostering and advancing the development of international organizations.
2. It operated on the principles of collective response and consensus-based decision-making. Through great-power consensus and mutual restraint, it maintained nearly a century of peace among European states and ensured stability on the European continent.
3. The conference procedures adopted during the Concert of Europe also introduced innovations, leading to the creation of numerous new rules of procedure tailored to practical needs.
4. The Concert of Europe directly led to the establishment of the earliest international administrative bodies—the Central Commission for Navigation on the Rhine (Rhine River Commission) and the European Commission of the Danube (Danube River Commission).

III. THE EARLY DEVELOPMENT OF INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATIONS

- - The first wave of international bodies were international administrative organizations, administrative unions, or “universal unions.”
- - Their primary purpose was practical cooperation among states on matters of shared interest.
- - They were functionally oriented, promoting technical collaboration.
- Examples: the International Telegraph Union and the Universal Postal Union.

(1) THE INTERNATIONAL ADMINISTRATIVE UNIONS

- The international administrative unions were the forerunners of modern international organizations.
- They fostered inter-governmental cooperation and interaction, aiming at specialized and technical collaboration across a wide range of professional fields, thereby providing a channel for governments to discuss and handle issues of common concern.
- They created permanent bodies—the International Bureaux—which became the prototype of today's international-secretariats and institutionalized the previously disjointed sequence of ad-hoc conferences.
- Each union established two organs—a General Assembly and a Council—enhancing operational capacity:
 - General Assembly: the deliberative body composed of all member states;
 - Council: the executive body composed of a limited number of member states elected by the Assembly, empowered to implement policies on behalf of the Assembly between sessions.

(2) NON-GOVERNMENTAL INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATIONS (EXEMPLIFIED BY PACIFIST ASSOCIATIONS)

1. - In 1815 the world's first pacifist bodies—the New York Peace Society and the Massachusetts Peace Society—were founded in New York and Massachusetts respectively.
2. - Similar societies soon appeared on the European continent: London (1816) and Geneva (1830).
3. - In 1867 Victor Hugo, Giuseppe Garibaldi and others established the League of Peace and Freedom in Geneva.
4. - In 1863 the Swiss Henry Dunant created the first international humanitarian relief organization—the “International Committee for the Relief of Wounded Soldiers” (also known as the “Geneva Five-Man Committee”).

(3) THE HAGUE SYSTEM

1. - Emerged from the two Hague Peace Conferences held in 1899 and 1907.
2. - Laid the cornerstone for the institutionalization of international organizations.
3. Introduced valuable experiments and innovations:
 - Universal membership: participation for the first time extended beyond Europe.
 - Principle of sovereign equality: equal voting rights, one vote per state.
 - Peaceful settlement of disputes: non-contending states could also intervene to facilitate a peaceful solution.
 - Voting innovation: a quasi-unanimity rule—consensus required except for abstentions.

SECTION TWO
INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATIONS IN THE
TWENTIETH CENTURY

I. THE ESTABLISHMENT AND EVOLUTION OF THE LEAGUE OF NATIONS

- - Founded on 10 January 1920.
- - Marked the opening of a new phase in the history of international organizations.
- Compared with the “Concert of Europe,” its institutional and legal character was significantly enhanced:
 - – Institutionally, the League was a tangible body endowed with international legal personality.
 - – Formally, the Covenant of the League—adopted by the Assembly—was a binding legal instrument that codified principles, rules, and decision-making procedures for international security.

PRINCIPAL ORGANS OF THE LEAGUE OF NATIONS

- ① - Assembly, Council, Secretariat, and the Permanent Court of International Justice.
- ② - Numerous subsidiary bodies: specialized commissions and advisory committees created by the Assembly and the Council.
- ③ - Statutorily independent organs: the Permanent Court of International Justice and the International Labour Organization.
- ④ - Cooperative agencies: institutions such as the International Institute of Intellectual Cooperation, the International Institute for the Unification of Private Law, and the International Educational Cinematographic Institute that worked with the League.

(I) THE ASSEMBLY AND THE COUNCIL OF THE LEAGUE OF NATIONS

- (1) The Assembly
 - - Modeled on the multilateral diplomatic conferences that had been held for centuries.
 - - Each member state had one vote, and decisions required the unanimous consent of all members.
- (2) The Council
 - - The Council was the most important organ of the League of Nations.
 - - Initially composed of representatives from five permanent members and four non-permanent members.
 - - It possessed the same powers as the Assembly, and in addition had the authority to expel member states, allocate mandate territories, and recommend specific military action to governments.
 - - Operated on the principle of “collective unanimity.”

(II) THE SECRETARIAT AND THE PERMANENT COURT OF INTERNATIONAL JUSTICE

- (3) The Secretariat
 - - The Secretariat was the League's administrative servicing body, staffed by a Secretary-General, secretaries, and clerical personnel.
 - - Its civil servants were international in character: recruited solely on merit by the League itself, independent of national nomination.
 - - Their remuneration was set at an exceptionally generous level to ensure continuity of service.
- (4) The Permanent Court of International Justice
 - - Core principles: sovereign equality of states; voluntary acceptance of jurisdiction; and a democratic rule that arbitral decisions be taken by majority while respecting dissenting opinions.
 - - The judicial system was further refined:
 - “Arbitrators” were replaced by permanent “judges,” forming the Court's core.
 - Judges were elected jointly by the Assembly and the Council of the League.
 - The bench was fixed at eleven judges (later raised to fifteen), supplemented by four deputy-judges, replacing the earlier system under which each member state could appoint up to four arbitrators.

II. THE ESTABLISHMENT AND EVOLUTION OF THE UNITED NATIONS

KEY MILESTONES IN THE FOUNDING OF THE UNITED NATIONS

- | Date | Milestone |
|---------------------|---|
| June 1941 | The Declaration of St. James's Palace (London) – first step toward creating the United Nations. |
| January 1942 | Representatives of 26 states (including China, the United States, the United Kingdom, and the USSR) sign the Declaration by United Nations in Washington, first use of the term “United Nations.” |
| October 1943 | Representatives of China, the United States, the United Kingdom, and the USSR meet in Moscow and issue the Four-Nation Declaration on General Security. |
| August–October 1944 | Dumbarton Oaks Conference produces proposals for the structure of the United Nations. |
| 25 April 1945 | Fifty nations convene the United Nations Conference on International Organization in San Francisco. |
| 25 June 1945 | The Charter of the United Nations is adopted. |
| 26 June 1945 | Representatives of 50 states sign the Charter of the United Nations. |
| 24 October 1945 | The Charter enters into force and the United Nations is officially established. |

(I) PURPOSES OF THE UNITED NATIONS

As set forth in the Charter of the United Nations:

- To maintain international peace and security;
- To develop friendly relations among nations based on respect for the principle of equal rights and self-determination of peoples;
- To achieve international cooperation in solving international problems of an economic, social, cultural, or humanitarian character;
- To be a center for harmonizing the actions of nations in the attainment of these common ends.

(II) PRINCIPLES OF THE UNITED NATIONS

1. Sovereign equality of all Member States.
2. Fulfillment in good faith of Charter obligations.
3. Peaceful settlement of international disputes.
4. Refraining from the threat or use of force.
5. Collective assistance in actions taken under the Charter.
6. Ensuring that non-Member States act in accordance with these principles so far as necessary for the maintenance of international peace and security.
7. Non-intervention in matters essentially within the domestic jurisdiction of any State.

(III) HISTORICAL STAGES OF THE UNITED NATIONS

- (1) The early years of the UN: a hegemonic instrument dominated by the United States.
- (2) After the 1960s, during the Cold War: the UN became an arena for U.S.–Soviet rivalry, and the Security Council veto was wielded by both sides as a weapon in their confrontations.
- (3) After the 1960s, as decolonization accelerated: the UN evolved into a forum for Third-World states to oppose hegemonism and power politics, and a venue where small and medium-sized countries could assert justice, thereby expanding its role in maintaining world peace and promoting global development.

(III) HISTORICAL STAGES OF THE UNITED NATIONS (CONTINUED)

(4) The 1990s – after the Cold War

- UN activities spread to every corner of the globe.
- The agenda widened dramatically: global warming, ecological balance, arms control and disarmament, regional conflicts, peace-keeping and disaster relief, anti-money-laundering, anti-smuggling, anti-narcotics, anti-poverty, HIV/AIDS prevention, plus education, science, technology, culture and human rights.
- Peace-keeping evolved into multi-functional operations encompassing political, social, economic and humanitarian tasks, growing sharply in both number and size.

III. OTHER INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATIONS AFTER WORLD WAR II

1. A host of economically oriented international bodies were created.
2. - Region-based organizations multiplied rapidly, becoming a major component of the global institutional system.

Reasons:

- The East–West divide turned regional alliances into key vehicles for each camp.
 - To safeguard their own security and interests and to restore Europe's international standing and competitiveness, Western European states embarked on a path of unity and self-strengthening.
1. – South–South cooperation among developing countries likewise fueled the growth of regional groupings.
 2. - Producer-based commodity organizations were also established, e.g., the Organization of the Petroleum Exporting Countries (OPEC), the International Cocoa Organization, and the International Coffee Organization.

SECTION THREE
INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATIONS IN THE
TWENTY-FIRST CENTURY

I. THE EVOLUTION OF INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATIONS IN THE 21ST CENTURY

- In the twenty-first century, both the international structure and the global context have undergone new changes:
- – The collective rise of developing states has altered the balance of power between North and South, propelling the democratization of international relations.
- – The United States, Europe and other Western developed countries have tightened their coalition, seeking to delay the transfer of power to emerging-market states by retaining leadership over international rules.
- – Events such as 9/11, the wars in Afghanistan and Iraq, and the U.S. sub-prime mortgage crisis have made both traditional and non-traditional security threats increasingly prominent on the international agenda.

I. THE EVOLUTION OF INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATIONS IN THE 21ST CENTURY

- (1) The United Nations' areas of activity and influence have continued to expand.
- - In September 2000 the UN convened the Millennium Summit, at which world leaders unanimously adopted the Millennium Development Goals (MDGs).
 - – Aim: to cut global poverty in half by 2015 (using 1990 as the baseline), signalling a shift in UN priorities toward development.
- - In 2003 the United States bypassed the UN, launched a war against Iraq and occupied the country militarily.
 - – This unilateral, hegemonic action dealt the single greatest blow to the authority of the world's premier international organization since the end of the Cold War, exposing the UN's limited capacity to confront raw power.

I. THE EVOLUTION OF INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATIONS IN THE 21ST CENTURY

- (2) Developing countries have joined forces to strengthen themselves, raising their voice in global affairs.
- - The Group of 20 has gradually replaced the Group of 8—previously composed mainly of Western industrialized states—as the primary forum for international economic coordination, operating through annual summits.
- - In June 2009 the leaders of Brazil, China, India and Russia held the first BRIC summit, launching the BRIC cooperation mechanism.
- - At the third summit in April 2011, hosted by China, South Africa was admitted as a full member, creating the BRICS platform for emerging economies.
- - The Executive Board of the International Monetary Fund approved a quota and governance reform package that shifts roughly 6 percent of quota shares to dynamic emerging markets and under-represented developing countries.

- (3) Regional international organizations have likewise achieved substantial growth.
- - European Union: launch of the euro, eastward enlargement, and the Constitutional Treaty.
- - Asia-Pacific regional integration and institutional building have registered major advances:
 - – The ASEAN-Plus-Three (APT) framework: ten ASEAN states plus China, Japan and South Korea, together with three parallel “10+1” mechanisms.
 - – China and ASEAN signed the Framework Agreement on Comprehensive Economic Cooperation, setting 2010 as the target for establishing a China–ASEAN Free Trade Area.
 - – Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation (APEC).
 - – Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB).

II. THE IMPACT OF GLOBALIZATION ON INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATIONS

1. - Economic globalization has deepened political and economic interdependence among states, accelerating the momentum of regional integration.
2. - It has turned the world into a closely knit “global village,” while rapid advances in high technology have created the technical infrastructure for international organizations to expand.
3. - Global economic crises under globalization have underscored the need for enhanced international cooperation, thereby spurring the growth of international organizations.
4. - Globalization has generated a host of trans-border problems, raising the bar for global governance and thus propelling the development of international organizations.

III. EMERGING TRENDS OF INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATIONS

1. Accelerated globalization, digitalization, and societal participation.
2. The collective rise of developing countries.
3. Deepening regional integration.
4. Expanded cooperation in non-traditional domains.

IV. FUTURE PROSPECTS FOR INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATIONS

1. - Developing countries will steadily raise their level of engagement in international organizations.
2. - An increasing number of these states are joining forces to demand reforms in institutional structures and rules, thereby enhancing their status and influence.
3. - By accelerating South-South cooperation, they will create new, developing-country-led organizations to advance international cooperation and the formulation of new norms.
4. - Cooperation and coordination among international organizations will be further strengthened.
5. - Regional organizations will expand both in depth and in breadth.
6. - The influence and role of non-governmental international organizations in global politics will continue to grow.

REVIEW QUESTIONS

1. What are the main conditions and methods for the creation of international organizations?
2. What are the main characteristics of international organization development following World War II?
3. Why is the United Nations considered the most universal, representative, and authoritative intergovernmental international organization?
4. What are the main factors influencing the future development of international organizations?